📓 Day 9 Notes ✏️

Redesigning the Store UI (My Recap)

★ Today = a visual redesign ONLY. The store works the same as before, it just looks much better. I used two prompts, with a test in between.

1 The Rules for Today

- No logic changes: routes, cart and API calls stay exactly the same
- Do NOT edit ProductDetail.jsx, the server folder, or the tryon folder

Why? Fahad is changing ProductDetail.jsx at the same time. If two people edit the SAME file on different branches, git can't combine them automatically. That's called a merge conflict. Splitting the files avoids it.

2 Before Pictures

```
git checkout main
git pull
git checkout -b feature/ui
cd client
npm install
```

I took BEFORE screenshots of the home page and the cart page, so I could compare with AFTER later.

3 Give the AI a Clear Design Brief

"Make it look nice" gives a boring, generic result. A clear brief gives a much better one:

- Style: modern, minimal fashion boutique
- Colours: warm off-white background, near-black text, ONE accent colour
- Fonts: a serif font for headings, a clean sans-serif for body text
- Space: generous white space

Lesson: the more specific the direction, the better the result.

4 New Idea: Design Tokens (CSS Variables)

```
/* simplified example */
:root {
  --color-accent: /* my accent colour */;
  --space-4: 1rem;
  --radius: 12px;
}

.button {
  background: var(--color-accent);
  border-radius: var(--radius);
}
```

I define colours, spacing and radius ONCE in index.css, then use them everywhere. To change the look, I change one place, and every page stays consistent.

5 New Idea: Responsive Layouts

```
/* simplified example */
.grid {
  display: grid;
  grid-template-columns: repeat(4, 1fr);
}
@media (max-width: 900px) {
  .grid { grid-template-columns: repeat(2, 1fr); }
}
```

The product grid has 4 columns on desktop, 2 on a tablet and fewer on a phone. To test a phone: press F12, then Ctrl + Shift + M.

6 What I Redesigned

- Prompt 1: design tokens, a sticky header with a cart count badge, a footer, a hero section, and the product grid with nicer cards
- Prompt 2: the cart page (items on the left, a sticky summary on the right), the checkout page (form on the left, summary on the right), and the order confirmation card

Product cards use aspect-ratio: 4 / 5 and object-fit: contain. Later our products will be transparent PNG cutouts of clothes, and "contain" shows the whole garment without cropping it.

7 Why Two Prompts?

A big task split into two smaller ones gives the AI less to juggle, so the result is better. And I could TEST Part 1 before asking for Part 2.

8 Checks and Pushing

- git status should list only files inside client. If server, ProductDetail.jsx or tryon appear, tell Fahad.
- Walk through the store like a customer: home, add to cart, cart, checkout, order page. Everything must still WORK.
- Check phone view, then take the AFTER screenshots

```
git add .
git commit -m "Redesign store UI"
git push -u origin feature/ui
```

💡 **Big takeaway:**

A clear design brief beats "make it nice". Design tokens keep every page consistent from one place. Responsive layouts adapt to phones. Different people should edit different files, to avoid merge conflicts. Next: search, sort and filter on the product list.